



1. The Bloody Mary, according to cocktail lore, is named after British Queen Mary

2. In spite of what James Bond says, a martini is better stirred than shaken

3. Named after Count Camillo Negroni of Florence, the negroni is a gin and Campari cocktail

called *aguardiente*—which translates to fire water or burning water—and is a very early precursor to rum. Made of sugarcane, the spirit tasted incredibly rough. Along with this, they also had local ingredients like lime, sugarcane and mint. Due to the medicinal qualities of the ingredients, they started mixing the *aguardiente* along with the herbs to ease its flavour while also reaping the benefits of the herbs simultaneously. And thus the origin of the mojito cocktail came about,” explains Ax. In 1862, Don Facundo Bacardi, started producing rum where he derived the style and technique of making *aguardiente* in Cuba. However, he wanted to ensure it was more palatable and accessible. So, he used a two-method distilling process, creating the first Bacardi variant, explains Ax.

The mojito is one of the most popular cocktails globally and its simplistic nature gives it so much room for variation and interpretations, says

Tarun Sibal, chef and entrepreneur of Goa-based culinary bar Titlie where he serves a Dragonball mojito with Bacardi Ocho, pink dragonfruit, lime and lychee. “Mojito is the quintessential Cuban rum cocktail, but more than a cocktail it’s a vibe. Mojito emotes the sea, the sun, the joy of life and a vacation,” says Sibal.

In Miami’s Little Havana area, the mojito is the most popular drink among the local population of Cuban descent, as well as visitors. What makes the mojitos here different are the sugarcane sticks used to muddle the drink and also used as a garnish. A representative of Ball and Chain, one of the oldest bars in the area, explains, “Sugarcane is very close to our Cuban heritage. It is also perfect to bite when soaked in mojitos. So it is a combination of paying tribute to our Cuban history, adding a fun element to your drink and that delicious sugary taste that people with Cuban heritage love and know.”